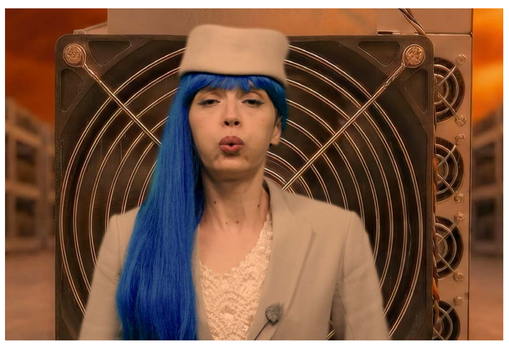
Portfolio

Vytautas Jankauskas — 2026

2026



COLLABORATORS

Maria Gutta
Anaelle Jud

COMMISSION

FACT Liverpool

EXHIBITIONS

Can Meeple Escape the Neurophoria? at FACT Liverpool (2026)

DOCUMENTATION

Video

LIFE FOREVER

Life Forever is an immersive installation and interactive film intertwining jellyfish adaptation, cryptominer waste heat, and human energy-hungry desires. The project satirizes techno-solutionism and asks how our pursuit of comfort, pleasure, and speculative value feeds cycles of consumption and the climate crisis.

Borrowing its title from Life . . . Forever, a karaoke song by Mr Immortal Jellyfish Man (the alter ego of marine biologist and karaoke enthusiast Dr Shin Kubota), the work invites visitors to reflect on value systems through the entangled pleasure of purgatory, entropy, existence and decay.

We emit heat, and therefore we are. Inspired by physicist Jeremy England's theory of dissipation-driven adaptive organisation—which proposes that life emerges as matter optimising its capacity to harness energy and disperse heat—the installation reframes humanity as an entropy-generating organism, the thermodynamic kin of crypto miners.

Within this ironic space of thermodynamic mediation, Life Forever stages a dialogue between humans, machines and jellyfish. A Tamagotchi-like decision-making system allows participants, guided by hostess Lola, to balance or disrupt flows of profit and heat. Depending on their choices, humans are invited onto the karaoke stand to sing Life . . . Forever, its lyrics reworked to echo the project's context—enacting a ritual of immortality.

Shamelessly balancing satire and systems thinking, Life Forever becomes a saturated rehearsal for a warming world. It invites us to consider whether we continue mining heat for abstract value, or learn from organisms that metabolise crisis into continuity—reimagining survival not as dominance, but as thermodynamic attunement.

LATENT INTIMACIES

2024—2025

Rather than seeking smooth, seamless interactions, the project leverages the constraints and vulnerabilities of AI to imagine other possible forms of intimacy between humans and machines.

Latent Intimacies uses interviews, observation, and prototyping to produce three raw studies — refracting intimacy through three personalized AI models for voice synthesis and language generation.

Demolition (top image), a block of porcelain and resin, encapsulates online exchanges with friends and loved ones who agreed to participate. Drawing from this tiny intimate corpus to formulate the best possible response, the voice agent then permanently deletes its response from the dataset, gradually erasing its own memory.

Inspired by a mystical social game played by Mexican children, Red Book (bottom left), blends chance, prophecy, and divination. Its activation relies on a specific set of protocols, emphasizing both engagement and the importance of disengagement.

The last study intertwines the daily lives of Cats, their guardians, and the community. A camera worn by a cat captures snapshots, which the AI translates into short poems, attempting to imitate the feline. Present but elusive, it moves at its own pace, offering pleasure on its own terms, without being governed.

These devices aim to question the current trajectory of mainstream AI and reveal possible futures. What else could AI be? The three prototypes have little commercial value, but they offer alternative paths into the digital world, promising slower, more thoughtful connections.

COMISSION

Medialab Matadero

SHOWS

Exposition de la Bourse de la Ville de Genève, Le Commun, Geneva, Switzerland (2025)

AIxDesign Festival, Amsterdam, The Netherlands (2025)

Feelings, Inc. Privacy Salon, Huidenclub, Rotterdam, The Neterlands (2025)

Lab#3 Showcase, Medialab Matadero, Madrid, Spain (2024)

COLLABORATORS

Paulina Casas,
Janire Goikoetxea,
Valeria Castillo,
Justin Pickard,
Moises Ramirez,
Marbles the Cat

DOCUMENTATION

Github
Feelings, Inc. Symposium Talk
Medialab Matadero Presentation

ALTAR-3000 Smart Home Altar in action.

ALTAR-3000

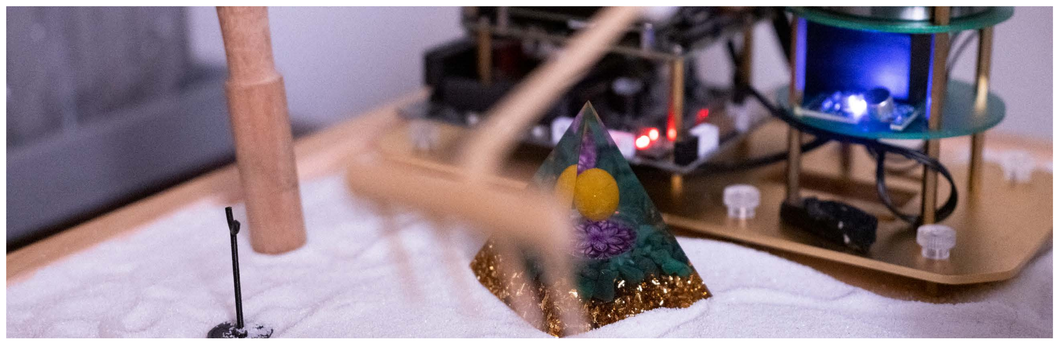
2022

The automated sand garden—adorned with paraphernalia that might have meant something once but doesn't reflect much in the age of multitude of easily digestible truths—disseminates its prophecies on conspiracy forums.

The smart home shrine explores the notion of an AI prophet, a automated totem of customised belief. The home altar connects to the internet to retrieve latest betting headlines from PredictIt, humanity's financial positions on the near future IRL. The (smart home) altar is adorned with paraphernalia that might have meant a lot once but doesn't reflect much in the age of digestible truths. The device evokes revitalised New Age aesthetics from the times of cyber hippies, when internet utopias constituted where gods and transcendence were to be found.

Trained on writings of prominent prophetic classics like Nostradamus, to more recent stars such as Yuval Noah Harrari, to compilations of Q's drops themselves, lightly styled with a layer of politically-oriented poetry, the home shrine produces a short, prophecy-resembling, poetic yet often inconsistent message for a chosen bet headline. Upon vocal request, ALTAR-3000 will share the message with the global community by uploading it to 8kun conspiracy forum's "random" section. If the post is blocked by caption verification, user will need to help the altar by spelling the captcha aloud; a prayer of sorts.

As opposed to boring AIs and abstract, ephemeral algorithms quietly taking over parts of our life, ALTAR-3000 is blunt, bold, tangible, and Luddite-friendly. Should one disagree with such an object, the good old ethernet or power cables can be unplugged conveniently for a prompt disconnect. So far, ALTAR-3000 has not been banned on 8kun it appears.



COMISSION

Chronus Art Center

SHOWS

WeLink:Sideways,
Chronus Art Center (2021)

PUBLICATIONS

The Art Journal
online (07.2024)

Neural Magazine
online (08.2022) & print :
Issue 70, Autumn (2021), p.19

Creative Applications
online (01.2022)

COLLABORATORS

Robin Luo
Ni Yang
Jiawen Yao
Ding Ding,
Leon Eckert

MORE

Video

A METALLIC REFRIGERATOR, SITTING INSIDE OF A KITCHEN

2021

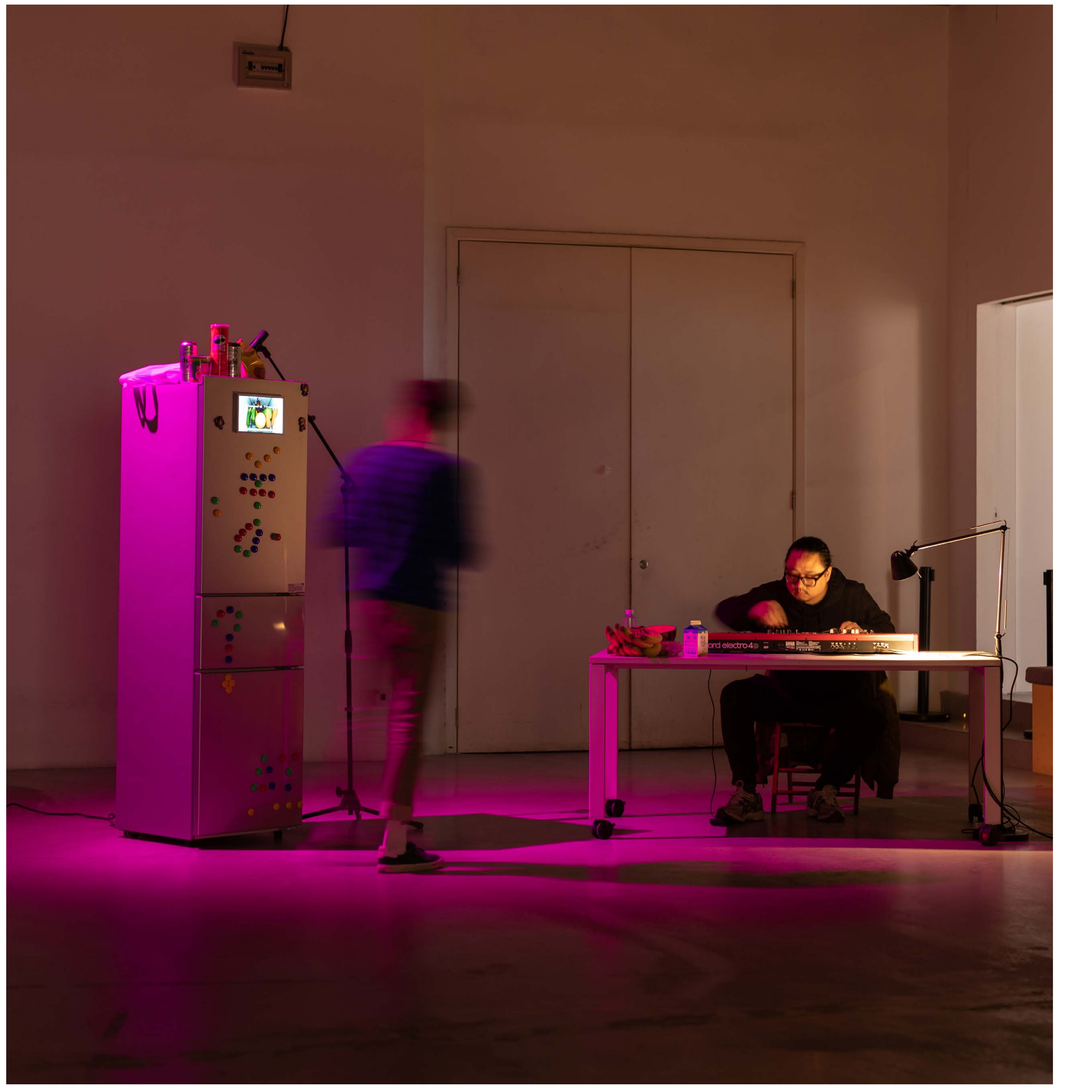
In collaboration with experimental musician Gooooose (Han Han), the performance consists of a melancholically singing AI-enhanced fridge and Gooooose accompanying it on a synth.

The duet ironically looks at human-AI “collaboration” whilst simultaneously inviting to perceive today’s ubiquitous domestic appliances with revived thrill and re-evoked sentiments of endearment.

A smart fridge has observed the human long enough to be ready for a stage; world’s first singing fridge, a poet with means to perceive the world radically different from us, humans. Liberated from the dull experience of looking at food as a commodity, the fridge now takes it as input for what humans would define as creativity. See, tech companies talk creativity all the time, turning it into a capitalist concept, but inspiration is quite something else. Therefore, a concert brought about by an AI fridge and a man, attempts to draw new territories in what it means to be creative, and what it means to be inspired.

With a consensus that at this stage of AI development a machine has no substantial (if any) benefit from what we humans tend to define as “collaboration”, we have ventured into the inevitably anthropomorphic grey area of letting an AI fridge be what it wants to be. A singer, that is.

Our refrigerator is fitted with a computer running image captioning and text generation AI algorithms, a Max patch for turning text-to-speech into harmonies, a webcam, a custom-fitted display, and a speaker. Gooooose plays on a Nord piano, at times using vegetables to trigger certain notes.



COMISSION

Chronus Art Center in partnership with Goethe Insistut.

SHOWS

Project Room, Chronus Art Center, special performance for the opening of “AI Delivered: Redemption” (2021)

COLLABORATORS

Han Han (GOOOOOSE)

MORE

Video

Process and Roo in their natural habitat, ‘Unfamiliar Covenient’ with Claire Glanois.

UNFAMILIAR CONVENIENT 2021

COLLABORATORS

Claire Glanois
Jiawen Yao
Robin Luo
Daxu Cao
Jake C Rees

SHOWS

SmART Exhibition, Smartification of Everything Symposium, University of Ottawa (2022)

PUBLICATIONS

Smartification of Everything, University of Toronto Press (2025 : forthcoming)

MORE

Video

Unfamiliar Convenient is set to challenge the limits of smart home objects in order to introduce a range of peculiar behaviours. What if domestic appliances were to be considered a species?

Unfamiliar Convenient attempts to at least remotely consider everyday devices as species; to champion boolean intelligence as inherently different from anything else we've known so far. The projects is built on the ideas of object-oriented ontology (Harman) which discards human superiority over objects, and the stemming theory of object phenomenology (Wonder is the way objects orient, in Alien Phenomenology or What It's Like to be an Object, Bogost, p.124).

Unfamiliar Convenient is set to challenge the factory limits of smart home. The inquiry into devices' tehnical properties as species denominators seeks to unravel new ways of looking at technology in a home. Our hope is to evoke sentiments of appreciation, attachment, and respect to technological things we make—all part of the Anthropocene layer—demonstrating how devices become smart when not forced to be human-like. The first inquiry in a series builds on a relationship between a voice assistant (turned agent) and a vacuum cleaner, situated in a wider ecosystem they inhabit.

More devices are expected to join the family over time in an endeavor to define a different home ecosystem. The internet of Things speaks of a theater of devices, an ecology that coexists with the human and other entities inhabiting a home, constituting less hierarchical relationships between the natural, the human, and the artificial. Under these new terms, assemblages of co-inhabitance and reimagined configurations of our most intimate spaces are to be discovered and experimented with, acknowledging more equal relationships between us, our surroundings, and then things we make.

WE LEAK TOO

2021

Aside from listening to voice commands, the interactive voice assistant “listens” for unencrypted network communications from other artworks in the exhibition, appropriating captured content to its own ends.

Voluntarily or not, nearly all connected devices leak information. In a data-hungry world, being able to intercept digital information in one way or another becomes a significant leverage in sectors ranging from surveillance to commerce. Smart TVs overhear conversations, Roombas draw floor plans with the implied potential of selling them to third parties, Alexas get built into routers gaining access to our browsing patterns, and so on.

Over time, substantial amounts of network traffic have been secured through encryption. I.e. https protocol that largely replaced plain-text http now encrypts packets to the point where one might guess their type (mail, web request, audio, etc.) based on size and communication port, but may not access the content itself. Nonetheless, some packets remain open and can be read.

We Leak Too is an overly honest open-source voice assistant with an integrated packet sniffer. Every time a packet goes through its local network, the device will announce it being logged. If a plain-text packet gets intercepted, its contents are read aloud. The device otherwise acts as a regular voice assistant, serving commands, telling the wether, making lame jokes.

Since device’s local network mainly consists of computers running artworks, the intercepted data results in bootleg mashups questioning unsupervised data as creative commons. Should the audience connect to CAC’s WiFi, their communications too will get caught in the mix.

COMISSION

Chronus Art Center

SHOWS

WeLink:Sideways,
Chronus Art Center (2021)

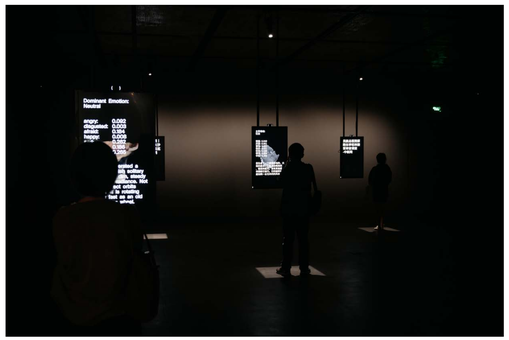
COLLABORATORS

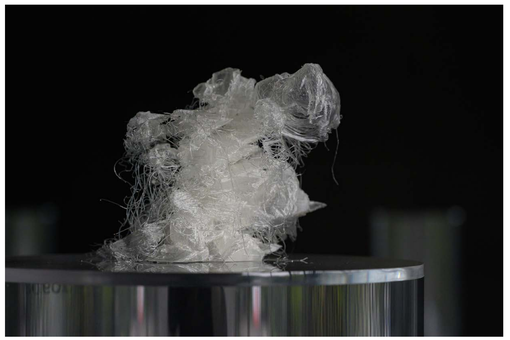
Leon Eckert
Material Design
Assistance from
Jiawen Yao

MORE

Website

UNKNOWN: YIN XIUZHEN X CAC LAB 2020





COMISSION

ZHI Art Museum &
CAC A&T@ Programm

PRODUCED BY

Chronus Art Center

CONCEPT

YIN Xiuzhen

PRODUCTION

BI Xin
CAO Daxu
CAO Jiamin
Vytautas Jankauskas
Miller Kilstner
Fito Segrera
YAO Jiawen

SHOWS

Yin Xiuzhen Solo Show,
Power Station of Art,
Shanghai (2024–25)

Topologies of the Real:
Techne Shenzhen Museum
of Contemporary Art and
Urban Planning, Shenzhen,
China (2023)

UNKNOWN, ZHI Art
Museum (2020–2021)

MORE

Website

An algorithmic system attempts to capture our emotional responses towards information we take for granted, generating and monumentalising universes as a form of documentation

As the Head of Research at the Chronus Art Center's Lab, with a talented team of artists, I was entrusted to lead the technological embodiment and development of the piece, identifying the technological tools, metaphors, and relationships between them, to give form to the artist's original concept.

UNKNOWN is the third iteration of the A&T@ Program initiated at Chronus Art Center, and another notable outcome of continued collaborations between ZHI Art Museum and Chronus. A&T@, conceived by media art curator ZHANG Ga, supports leading Chinese artists working in traditional media to venture into otherwise inaccessible channels of advanced programming and production facilities by pairing them with technologists to develop works that are unique and different from their established artistic vocabulary and formal strategies, thus opening up new horizons, furthering the experimental potential for these artists and, in turn, contributing to the development of art making in the twenty-first century.

UNKNOWN is an abstract digital archive. Up-to-date news headlines get converted into abstract imagery by a machine-learning algorithm. Upon engaging with a headline, audience's emotion metrics are captured. Images along with emotion data are in turn 'catalogued' in a generative 3d universe, becoming celestial bodies with behavioral properties defined by emotion analysis. At the end of each day, a universe is synthesised and stored in system's memory. The following morning as fresh headlines are written and a novel star map takes place, the algorithm attempts to cast a 3d-printed hard copy of the previous day's creation. These imperfect sculptures are souvenirs of entire universes downsampled.

CACHED

2018

COMISSION

Hive Creative Residency
at thecamp

COLLABORATORS

Clément Bouttier
Ryan Dzelzkalns
Jon Flint
Aline Martinez
Joana Mateus
Felipe de Souza

SELECTED SHOWS

Experimenta20'
Art & Science Biennial,
Grenoble, France (2020)

ISEA2019, Juried
Exhibition, Gwangju,
S.Korea (2019)

Higher Resolution: with
Hyphen Labs, Tate Modern,
London, UK (2019)

Chroniques Biennale of
Digital Art, Marseille,
France (2018)

PUBLICATIONS

Technologies of the Self-
portrait. Giannachi, G.
Routledge (2024)

MORE

Trailer Video

A glimpse at how psychographic algorithms have learned to view us and the assumptions they make.

Using IBM Watson and Cambridge Apply Magic Sauce, your social media personality is analysed and quantified. The algorithm generates a psychological profile that describes your personality, behaviors, and predilections:

“You enjoy a fast-paced, busy schedule with many activities”. “You think it is wrong to take advantage of others to get ahead.” “You are content with your level of accomplishment and do not feel the need to set ambitious goals”. “You are the content”.

Based on a textual analysis of your social media posts, Cached presents you a customised narrative highlighting your character traits, interests and consumer preferences. At the end of the experience, all personal data is erased, and the visitor receives a unique printed receipt containing a summary of the analysis. It is the only record of their data, which can be shared, kept secret, or destroyed at their convenience.

Psychographic algorithms often resemble a hybrid of digital psychologists and fortune-tellers. The interpretation of this sort might not be as accurate as direct data on clicks, GPS points or biometrics. Nevertheless, the very idea that we are perceived as social beings rather than quantitative datasets raises the data privacy discourse to a new level.

The project is a result of a collaborative effort by the Cached Collective. The collective first met during a summer residency in the South of France, the Hive. Each of us brought a distinct expertise to our collaboration that we leveraged to create a unique, multidisciplinary experience.

‘BreakingViews’ Instagram TV, ‘Somestic Media’ with Jon Flint.

SOMESTIC MEDIA 2018

COMISSION

New Talent Cohort,
Pervasive Media
Studio, Bristol

COLLABORATORS

Jon Flint

SHOWS

V&A Digital Design
Weekend,
London, UK (2019)

ISEA 2019,
Art Center Nabi
Gwangju, South Korea
(2019)

MORE

Video

A trio of connected objects, retrofitting complex social media interactions within the domestic appliances from the last century.

Each device pulls, processes and displays specific data from a major social network. However, the output of each device simply reports its information, depriving the user of any two-way interactions we are accustomed to in the digital age. This enforced isolation amplifies and exposes the presumably frictionless communication processes orchestrated by complex social media algorithms. The Somestic Media suite includes:

‘LastSeen’ — an alarm clock that goes off when a person of interest comes back online on Facebook, keeping track of how long ago the target individual was last active on the platform.

‘SoulMate’ — a radio that uses text synthesis to read the profiles of potential romantic partners on Tinder out loud and includes a special “Follow Mode” that can be accessed via a key switch, giving an accurate distance to each of your existing matches, and

‘BreakingViews’ — a television that displays Instagram stories from your feed and keeps track of how many times you have replayed a specific story.

The saturated display of the collected data conveys the impact social-media has on our perception of time, distance, and priority. Whose online presence do you follow, and why? What information on dating profiles is important, apart from the profile picture? What type of content — news or views — do we prefer and why?

The aim of Somestic Media is to critically render social media processes, make them more tangible. Such exposure is vital for understanding how the new technologies change the way we live and socialise, and the information we take for granted.

DIY Food Growing Space, ‘Mitigation of Shock’ with Superflux.

MITIGATION OF SHOCK

2017

An apartment from London around 30 years from now transformed for living with the consequences of climate change.

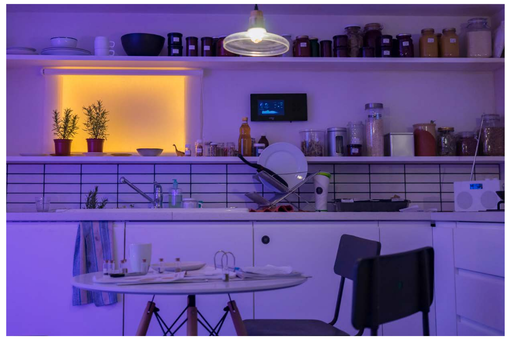
Using extrapolations from current climate change data, the project depicts a future world where economic and political fragility, broken supply chains, social fragmentation and food insecurity have become a norm.

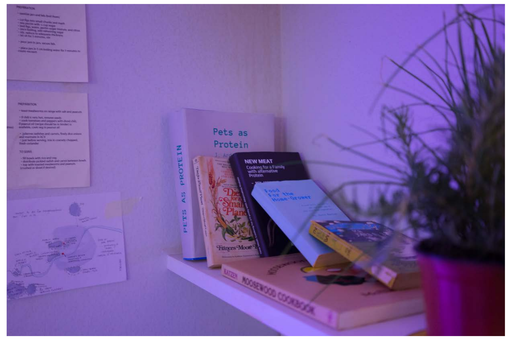
Once a comfortable space designed for a world of automated living, global trade and material abundance, the apartment has been adapted to a future that requires more of it than comfort. With the the detritus of obsolete smart devices and devalued designer goods, a new reality of survival emerges, formed by the impact of climate change.

Experimental food production and repurposed consumer goods now occupy space once meant for relaxation. Recipes in the kitchen reflect the change in food production, storage, and consumption. A radio show and discarded newspapers manifest the tensions of this new world.

Looking beyond, there lies a city familiar, yet alien, occupied by people internally displaced from low lying areas due to sea level rise and extreme weather events. Greenhouses dotted across rooftops. Smoke rising from sites of civil unrest. Further away, the skyline of the city buildings begun in a more prosperous time stand unfinished; monuments of the hubris of an other-wise forgotten time.

A mundane, in which the dream of smart home didn't fulfill its promises. A world of collapsed national governments. What can we learn from a future radically different from the ones depicted in glossy renders we are often presented with?





COMISSION

CCCB Barcelona

SHOWS

'After the End of the World',
CCCB, Bacelona
(2017 – 2018)

SUPERFLUX

Jon Ardern
Adith Dhanushkodi
Mikhaela Dietch
Jon Flint
Mael Henaff
Anab Jain
Vytautas Jankauskas
Alix McCabe
Jake Charles Rees

MORE

Video Interview

2015

SHOWS

V&A Digital Design Weekend
V&A, London (2016)

étapes selection
showcase, Galérie 12, Paris,
France (2015)

MA Degree Show,
Head Media Design,
Pavillon Sicli, Genève (2015)

PUBLICATIONS

Designing Futures:
Speculation, Critique,
Innovation. Groß, Leicht,
Mandir (2024)

Discursive Design: Critical,
Speculative, and Alternative
Things, B&M. Tharp, MIT Press
(2022)

AWARDS

Core 77 Award
Speculative
Concepts Student
Runner-Up (2016)

MORE

Tutorial video

HOW TO BUILD A WATER FILTER

A Youtube tutorial from the future reshapes our notions of nationality and citizenship, through a near-future microcosm, in which all water has become commodified.

The presented future is a saturated manifestation of corporate power and monetised citizenship, where policymaking has been outsourced to multinational companies. The project presents a reality where one's financial status determines one's water allowance. Tap water is accessible via dedicated national identity card extensions that come in Basic, Black and Gold versions.

A society where independent water filtering is proclaimed unsafe and therefore illegal, gives birth to water hacking. Convinced that natural resources should remain a universal human right, our water hacker has built a DIY water filter and published subversive instructional online tutorials, as well as useful tips for avoiding surveillance. Currently considered a tool for developing countries, in this future, a water filter has become a symbol of resistance for many.

The filter is built from everyday gardening materials, refurbished personal belongings, and several second-hand flea market acquisitions. The filtering mechanism consists of four steps: a slow sand filter, a silk filter, a short-range UV lamp for water sterilisation, and raw salts to re-mineralise the treated water.

Tangible, functional tools, designed for plausible future worlds, can provide a deeper understanding of the present, and help anticipate potential societal issues yet to come.

The Water Hacker, ‘How to Build a Water Filter: A Youtube Tutorial from the Future’.

ASSEMBLING INTELLIGENCE SYMPOSIUM (2024)

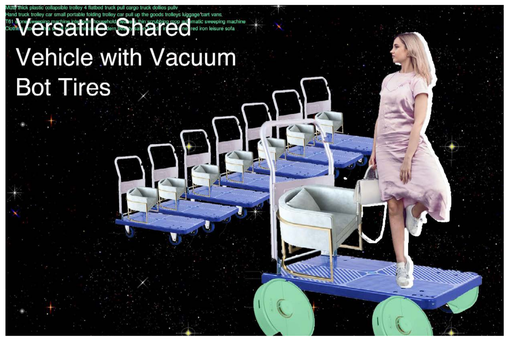
I co-organised Assembling Intelligence, an interdisciplinary 2-day symposium held at HEAD–Genève, exploring alternative perspectives on AI through art an design. The symposium invited hosted international speakers ranging from artists to scientists, as well as workshops, performances and screenings.

Social Networks of Tomorrow Programs at InnovationLab, La Plateforme (2022—23)

I organised two interdisciplinary post-graduate programs aimed at exploring futures of small-community-inspired social networks, in collaboration with Project Liberty. The program reports are avalaible here (2022) and here (2023), whereas the program's portfolio, incluing essays by Darius Kazemi, Sarah Friend, and myself, can be found here.

Shoppers Exposed Workshop with Claire Glanois (2021)

Together with a machine learning researcher Claire Glanois we held Shoppers Exposed, a workshop at Chronus Art Center in Shanghai that used machine-learning to analyse participants' TaoBao (Chinese 'Amazon') purchase histories and 'predict' (generate funky new product names based on previously bought items) what they might buy next.

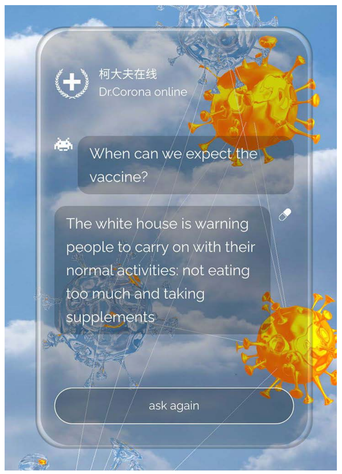


Allez bonne nuit with Francesco Garbo (2023)

We did a short film about people sleeping in VR for a contest by La Maif exploring futures of insurance and technology-related addictions.

WiFi Psychic Workshop with Leon Eckert (2021)

We did a workshop at Chronus Art Center in Shanghjao, introducing principles of internet security. We used network sniffing (ARP spoofing and packet reconstruction) in combination with Python to generate some graphics based on intercepted network data.



Dr. Corona Online with Ye Funa (2020)

I helped artist YE Funa develop DR.CORONA ONLINE, a natural language processing (GPT2) machine-learning-driven roboadvisor trained on Chinese 'chicken soup' (newspaper correspondence doctor popular in the 90s that used to give advice based on common sense rather than medicinal knowledge). The peace is part of We Link: Ten Easy Pieces online exhibition.

SIG, a voice assistant trainable on literature, ‘Our Friends Electric’ with Superflux.

Emotion Recognition Mirror with Superflux (2018)

I helped develop a facial recognition mirror that displays fictional ads based on facial expressions for 'The Future Starts Here' exhibition at the Victoria&Albert Museum in London, UK.

Logo for Logan Symposium's Conspiracy Edition (2018)

Commissioned by Jake Charles Rees, I designed and animated the logo for the Center for Investigative Journalism's Logan Symposium, theme of "Conspiracy", held at Goldsmiths, University of London.

The Future Energy Lab with Superflux (2017)

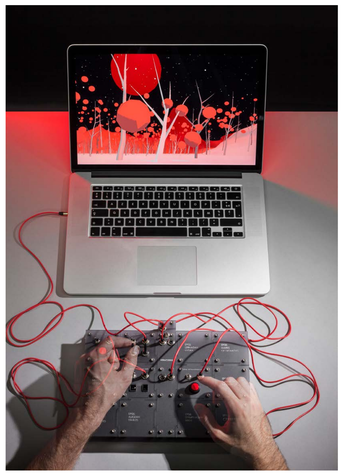
I designed the animation assets and the back-end of the interactive multiscreen framework. The table allowed navigating sustainable energy investment scenarios for the UAE Ministry of Energy.

Goldsmiths Summer School, with Jon Flint (2017)

I co-designed and ran a workshop for 14-16 year old visiting students from the Phil-lipines, exploring Jugaad (innovation with limited resources) and speculative design techniques as hands-on approaches for thinking about the future.

Our Friends Electric with Superflux (2017)

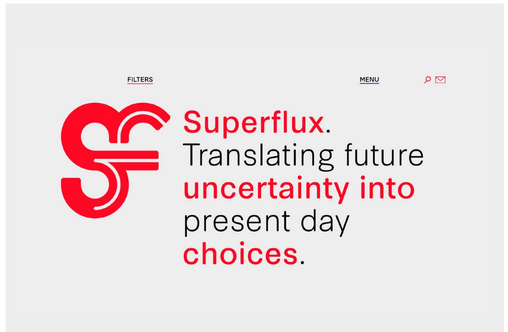
I worked on the production of Our Friends Electric, a short film by Superflux studio com-missioned by Mozilla Foundation that ex-plores the future of voice assistants.



Heracle555 with Félicien Goguey (2015)

I co-designed a series of analogue synthesiser modules connected to virtual environment, based on the Twelve Labours of Hercules. With each new episode sounds and challenges become increasingly more complex, forming an immersive audiovisual experience. Heracle555 uses 555 timer ICs and can also be used as an autonomous synthesiser.

3D pen for French chefs, Goldsmiths Design Summer School with Jon Flint.

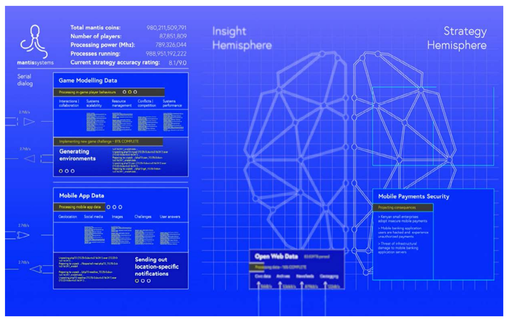


New Identity and Website with Superflux (2017)

I served as the project manager for the remake of Superflux studio's visual identity and website, assembling the team, figuring out the UX and ensuring cohesiveness of all elements.

Mantis Systems with Superflux (2018)

I designed the interface for Mantis, a fictional AI that proactively identifies and prevents global systems risks. This was part of the Mantis Systems project for the Bond 2018 Annual Intenational Development Conference, challenging the future of volunteering and tech-supported disaster relief.



Vermis Magnes (2015)

Fascinated by the magnetic and kinetic dynamism of cassette tape film, I designed and built an interactive installation for The Animal Party exhibition at Milan's Fuorisalone. As the magnetic tape is highly sensitive to vibration, tapping on the vivarium—or even people's footsteps through the room—causes the bits of film to dance.

RCVoluntair with Superflux (2018)

I designed the visual assets for RCVoluntair, a project engaging with the social and economic challenges that the humanitarian and development sector might face in the near future. RCVoluntair is an AI that uses machine learning combined with human force, to predict crisis and intelligently organise resources.

Muto Labs with Superflux (2017)

I helped design a fictional startup presented at the FundForum conference in Berlin, using visual props to trigger conversations about the future impact of AI and roboadvisory in the fund management sector.

Dynamic Genetics vs. Mann with Superflux (2018)

I was responsible for reviving a previous studio project which interrogates the future of illegal DIY genetics, for an exhibition at the Somerset House in London. The space was split into a display of evidence from the court case described in the project, and a physical DIY genetics lab from the future.